BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS

dSPACE

Test and simulation tools that help carmakers validate vehicle software before it reaches the road

REVENUE 2024	EMPLOYEES	FOUNDED	OWNER
>€460M (+14%)[32]	>2,900[15]	1988, Paderborn[16]	Hanselmann family (private)[32]

1 KEY PARTNERS

- AWS and Microsoft Azure: cloud delivery platforms[1,2]
- ○ NVIDIA: AI-generated test scenes[3] GROWTH
- Sensor makers (NXP, Hesai, OMNIVISION): sensor models[4,5,6]
- Engineering partners: FEV, Elektrobit[7,8]
- Standards bodies (ASAM) and universities[9,10]

2 KEY ACTIVITIES

- Develop test hardware and software[11,12]
- Manufacture test systems in Paderborn[13]
- Engineering services and turnkey test benches[14]
- Integrate partner sensor models and cloud setups[1,4,5]

3 KEY RESOURCES

- 2,900+ employees[15]
- 35+ years of real-time test know-how[16]
- Products: SCALEXIO, VEOS, SIMPHERA, AURELION, TargetLink[5,12,16]
- Acquired tech: data annotation, logging, security testing[15,17,18]
- ◇ New production site (planned for 2027)[19] FUTURE BET

4 VALUE PROPOSITIONS

- Cut development time and validation risk with one traceable toolchain, from virtual (SIL) to hardware (HIL) testing[12]
- Proven HIL test systems (chosen by BMW for its next vehicle generation, 2021)[20]
- ○ Cloud-scale virtual testing[1,21] GROWTH
- Realistic camera, radar and lidar simulation[5]
- Safety-certified code generation (ISO 26262)[22]
- ○ AI-assisted testing (AI agents, NVIDIA integration)[3,23] GROWTH

5 CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS

- Decades-long partnerships (BMW: 25+ years)[20]
- Resident engineers, support and training[14]
- Joint integration projects (e.g., Stellantis virtual workbench)[24]
- User conferences and academic programs[25,26]

6 CHANNELS

- Direct sales and on-site setup via subsidiaries in 10 countries[13,14,16,27]
- ○ Cloud delivery (AWS, Azure) and SDVerse marketplace[1,2,28] GROWTH
- Engineering partners (FEV turnkey benches)[7]
- Awareness: trade shows (CES, GTC, AGRITECHNICA)[3,12,29]

7 CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

- Carmakers: core segment (BMW, Stellantis)[20,24]
- Tier-1 and chip/sensor suppliers[4,30]
- Aerospace and defence[31]
- Agriculture and off-highway[29]
- Universities and research[26]

8 COST STRUCTURE

- Engineering and R&D staff: likely the largest cost (analyst view)[15]
- Field engineering, support and 10 foreign subsidiaries[14,27]
- Hardware components and manufacturing labor (analyst view)[13]
- ◇ One-time: new site investment, mid-double-digit €M, to 2027[19] FUTURE BET

9 REVENUE STREAMS

- Test hardware systems (HIL, prototyping)[11,12]
- ○ Cloud validation (SIMPHERA)[1] GROWTH
- Software tool licenses[16]
- Engineering services, maintenance and training[14]

DISCLOSURE
Private company. Revenue is published rounded (>€460M in 2024). 2025 revenue, profit, costs and revenue mix are not published.[32]

COMPETITIVE MOAT
High switching costs: test benches, models and test cases built on dSPACE are reused for years (analyst view).[12,20]

CURRENT CONDITIONS
~300 staff on short-time work since May 2026 because of weak orders.[33]

● Current core ○ Growth ◇ Future bet

Data as of 30 Oct 2026 · Small numbers = sources on page 2 · “Reported” = press-reported, not company-disclosed · “Analyst view” = synthesis from cited evidence

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Compiled from company filings, press releases and reputable press, each retrieved and checked during research. Items the research could not verify were left off the canvas.